Vladimir Kostelei

Senior Software Engineer, Platform

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PROFILE

Senior software engineer focused on platforms, with **19 years in software**, the last **eight at Yandex**. Moved Cloud Console services from VM instance groups to Kubernetes, launched UI infrastructure for two new cloud regions, and reduced the Yandex News production VM fleet from 2,500 to 1,000.

CKA-certified and hands-on with Kubernetes, Terraform, Helm, CI/CD, Linux, and observability.

CORE SKILLS

Programming	Go, Python, Bash, TypeScript
Platform and IaC	Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, Docker, IaC, PaaS
Cloud and systems	AWS, Linux, Nginx
Delivery and automation	TeamCity, GitHub Actions, Ansible, Packer, Vagrant
Observability / security	Prometheus, Grafana, Fluent Bit, WAF, Distroless images

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Smart Business Technologies / Yandex Cloud 2022 - 2026
Senior Software Engineer, Platform / Technical Lead Serbia

- Led the migration of Cloud Console and UI services from VM-based instance groups to Kubernetes, standardizing deployments and simplifying infrastructure operations.
- Built and launched UI infrastructure for two new cloud regions: Israel and Kazakhstan.
- Took two cloud products from inception to launch as technical lead: Cloud Center, a cloud-native operations platform, and Security Deck, a CNAPP product.
- Reduced common UI service image size by approximately 70% and lowered exposure to critical CVEs by leading the adoption of Distroless container images.
- Designed and operated a Fluent Bit logging pipeline handling approximately 12 MB/s, with Prometheus and Grafana monitoring and alerting.
- Led platform security improvements across UI services, including WAF integration and security-focused platform capabilities.
- Coordinated infrastructure work across up to 14 engineers while remaining hands-on in architecture, delivery, and production operations.

Yandex Cloud 2020 - 2022
Senior Software Engineer, Platform / Technical Lead Russia

- Designed and maintained deployment pipelines with TeamCity, Terraform, and Helm for Cloud Console and related services.
- Led the production migration of Yandex Cloud from cloud.yandex.ru to yandex.cloud.
- Migrated 30+ repositories from GitHub to Yandex's internal source-code platform.
- Supported production reliability for Cloud Console and related user-facing services through on-call rotations, incident response, root-cause analysis, and preventive fixes.

EARLIER SOFTWARE ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Yandex News 2018 - 2020
Senior Software Engineer / Technical Lead Russia

- Led frontend engineering for Yandex News and the launch of Yandex Sport, which reached 1.5M daily active users.
- Designed a shared React/TypeScript framework and led service migrations to it.
- Reduced the production VM footprint from 2,500 to 1,000 through application architecture, performance, and infrastructure improvements.
- Designed and implemented Protobuf support in a shared Yandex frontend library.

Mann, Ivanov and Ferber | Frontend Developer 2015 - 2018

Built and operated the company's e-commerce platform and supporting services with AngularJS, PHP, and Linux.

Earlier companies | Web Developer / PHP Developer 2007 - 2015

Built production web applications, SOAP services, search integrations, and infrastructure tooling using PHP, Node.js, Sphinx, Linux, iptables, and SVN.

CERTIFICATION

- **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)** - The Linux Foundation / CNCF

SELECTED PROJECTS AND SECURITY

- **Linktheca** - open-source project written in Go; source available on GitHub.
- Prize winner in Tinkoff (T-Bank) CTF and Yandex CTF; organizer of a CTF team; active on TryHackMe and Hack The Box.
- **Coding Overhead** - technical blog covering software engineering and infrastructure.
- Selected open-source work: V&G Blue (Hugo theme) and Screenshotgun (C++ screenshot utility).

EDUCATION

Altai State Technical University - Computer Science | 2005 - 2010

LANGUAGES

Russian - Native | English - Professional working proficiency | Serbian - Elementary